R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · EDITING DATA · LESSON 4

04 Change one cell, or many cells at once

Replace values with [row, column] <- value, for a single cell or a whole range of rows.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Change one cell with [row, column]
- Change a range of rows with 1:200
- Check every change with table()

The R code in this lesson

```
# Change one cell: row 115, column 2
Demographic[115, 2] <- "Male"

# Change many cells: rows 1 to 200, column 2
Demographic[1:200, 2] <- "Female"

# Check the result
table(Demographic$`Sex of household head`)

# Undo by setting them back
Demographic[1:352, 2] <- "Male"
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Sometimes you need to correct a value, like a typing mistake from the field. In this lesson, you will learn to change one cell, or many cells at once, using the row and column address, and to check every change with table. Let's correct some data carefully.

0:00 We start again from the full Demographic table: three hundred fifty two rows. Table shows one female and three hundred fifty one males.

0:12 To change one cell, we use its address: Demographic, square brackets, row one hundred fifteen, comma, column two. Then the arrow, and the new value: Male, in quotes.

0:30 Run it, then run table again. Now it says Male, three hundred fifty two. The one female value has changed.

0:45 To change many cells, use a range of rows. Demographic, rows one colon two hundred, column two, arrow, Female.

1:00 Run it, and view the table. The first two hundred rows now say Female. Table shows two hundred female, and one hundred fifty two male.

1:20 This is just for practice, of course. In real work, you would only change a value when you know it is wrong, for example after checking with the field team.

1:35 Let's set them back: rows one to two hundred, column two, Male. Run table again to check.

2:05 And here I change the single cell, row one hundred fifteen, back to Female. Table shows one female and three hundred fifty one male again, just like at the start.

2:45 Finally, rows one to three hundred fifty two: every row. Use ranges like this with care. Always check with table after each change. Excellent work today!